

MIXOLOGY

TREND



"Bartending is reconnecting with its roots, It's not just about flavour. It's about linking the drink to its origin, the land and the people behind it."

**ADI SAN, Ambar**

gence with black garlic caviar and herbaceous, low-impact ingredients, while Get The Worm introduces insects as a viable, low-emission protein—fat-washed into spirits and balanced with citrus and spice. It's sustainability without sacrifice, where flavour remains non-negotiable.

In Seoul, the conversation takes on a quieter, almost philosophical tone. At M+MS, co-founder An Kyoung-won views sustainability less as a trend and more as long-term research. "It's about ensuring the longevity of the industry," he says. Here, upcycling drives creativity. Quince from an on-site tree is distilled into house spirits, while darae—a wild Korean kiwi—is used both fresh and fermented into wine. Their cocktail Mogwa Atteoseo brings these elements together with house-fermented koji, resulting in a drink that is complex yet accessible. Guests don't just taste the ingredients, he explains, they see them, growing right outside.

Back home in Delhi, the shift is equally pronounced, though rooted in seasonality. At Sidecar, Minakshi Singh has long championed ingredient-led cocktails through a "cocktail of the month" programme. "How can a bar call itself seasonal and still serve mango in winter?" she asks.

Each month brings a new highlight, from bael and ber to mulberry, that are harvested annually from their own farm. These ingredients are turned into shrubs, cordials, and liqueurs across their bars, Sidecar, Cocktails & Dreams Speakeasy and The Brook, create drinks that guests now anticipate as part of a yearly plan. "It matters to people," she notes and asserts, "But only when it comes from genuine intent—not greenwashing."

What ties these diverse approaches together is a shared recalibration of what a cocktail represents. It is no longer just a mix of spirits or latest techniques, but a narrative of land, climate, culture, and responsibility.

Guests, too, are changing. These bar owners and mixologists describe a growing appetite not just for what's in the glass, but for where it comes from and why it matters. A drink made with foraged herbs or upcycled fruit carries with it a story, and increasingly, that story is as important as the taste.

And like at top kitchens earlier, this drinks story too starts now, and with a walk in the forest.